

INTERNATIONAL news

Analog Devices announces \$693.5 million investment in Ireland

US chipmaker Analog Devices Inc. (ADI) plans to invest \$693.5 million in a new research and development and manufacturing facility in Ireland. With the latest investment, Analog Devices is looking to triple its wafer production capacity at its European regional headquarters in the Raheen Business Park in Limerick, Ireland. The company said that the new 4,180-square-metre facility would create 600 jobs. ADI has sought funding for the proposed investment from the European Union's important projects of common European interest in microelectronics and communication technologies initiative.

Infineon and Schweizer collaborating to increase SiC chips' efficiency

Leading automotive semiconductors players Infineon Technologies AG and Schweizer Electronic AG have announced their collaboration plan on an innovative way to further increase the efficiency of chips based on silicon carbide (SiC). It is learnt that both companies are developing a solution to embed Infineon's 1200 V CoolSiC chips directly onto printed circuit boards. The partners believe that it will increase the range of electric vehicles and reduce the total system costs.

Infineon acquires tiny machine learning startup Imagimob

Infineon Technologies has acquired Sweden based startup Imagimob AB, an emerging platform provider for machine learning (ML) solutions for edge devices. Acquiring 100% of the shares, Infineon believes that the step will advance its position to offer a world-class ML solution and significantly complement its AI offerings. The official press release noted that 2013-born Imagimob provides a highly flexible and easy-to-use end-to-end machine learning toolchain focussing on delivering production-grade ML models. It didn't reveal the amount of the transaction.

Shell and Volkswagen working together for EV charging infra in Europe

Shell Germany and the Volkswagen Group have jointly unveiled a 'Flexpole charging station' in Goettingen in Germany. Calling



it the first innovative 150kW Elli Flexpole charging station, the partners added that with their new technology, the charging stations can be easily and flexibly installed, and the grid expansion can be accelerated. Shell and Volkswagen also plan to install the Flexpole charging station at other locations in Germany and Europe after a successful test operation. Volkswagen's battery storage system claims to enable connection to a low-voltage grid and charges the vehicle quickly.

Vitesco introduces EV tech that works without rare earth metals

Leading global supplier of modern drive technologies and electrification solutions Vitesco Technologies recently unveiled one of its innovations for sustainable and efficient electric driving at the 44th Vienna Motor Symposium. The company stated that as a result of life cycle engineering, the fourth generation of its fully integrated electric axle drive platform (EMR4, Electronics Motor Reducer) is being broadened by a new option to enable an even better life cycle assessment. Its platform development now entails a new rotor without permanent magnets. Interestingly, this rotor forms the core of an externally excited synchronous machine (EESM), which works without rare earth materials, hence cutting the carbon footprint.

DigiKey updates their logo and brand system

DigiKey (earlier Digi-Key) Electronics recently announced an update to its brand system, including a refreshed logo. The company believes that the updated logo and brand system is an evolution of its historic look that allows for design flexibility across digital platforms while reinforcing an engineered feel in a more modern, timeless way. The refreshed brand identity was designed by creative consultancy Lippincott to emphasize progress and connection with suppliers and customers while reflecting DigiKey's digital-first, forward-looking perspective. The new elements were launched during the EDS Leadership Summit held in Las Vegas. Last month, the company celebrated its 50th year in business.

Nokia launches 5G automated drone-in-a-box solution

Nokia recently announced its turnkey drone-in-a-box solution offering, which is designed to meet the growing demands of organisations like public safety agencies, smart cities, construction, energy, and defence. As per Nokia, it is the first CE-certified solution that meets the safety requirements of the European Union. Manufactured in Europe, the Nokia Drone Networks solution claims to connect over public and private 4G/LTE and 5G networks to enhance situational awareness for first responders and other professionals. In addition to assessing damage, these drones can be utilised in search and rescue activities. They can also be programmed to manage autonomous scheduled flights for applications like additional security at large events or to manage regular remote equipment inspections.

Fujifilm to acquire Entegris's semicon high-purity process chemicals business

Entegris, a leading supplier of advanced materials and process solutions for the semiconductor and other high-technology industries, recently announced that Fujifilm is going to acquire Entegris' electronic chemicals business for \$700 million. Under this business, the company supplies high-purity process chemicals, which are utilised in the semiconductor manufacturing process to clean, etch, and dry the wafer during multiple stages of the chip fabrication process. The company expects to use the \$700 million of proceeds from the sale to accelerate debt paydown.

Ryder launches combined electric vehicle and charging capabilities

Leading player in the supply chain, dedicated transportation, and fleet management solutions Ryder System recently unveiled RyderElectric+™ as its new turnkey electric vehicle (EV) fleet solution. In an officially released statement, the company noted that its solution will partner with customers throughout the full journey of fleet electrification and will serve as a centralised source for Ryder's best-in-class fleet-management services in financing, facility infrastructure, charging, and maintenance for commercial EVs.